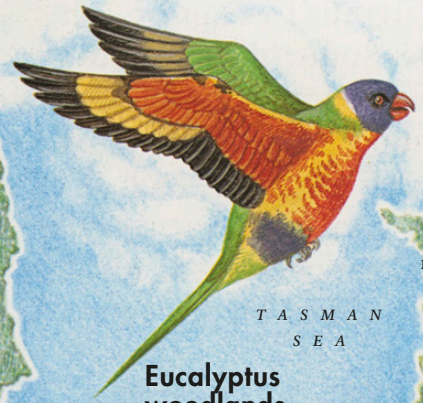




The outback of Australia consists of dry grassland and desert. This is partly due to the Great Dividing Range in the east, which stops moist winds from the Pacific Ocean reaching the middle of the continent.



Eucalyptus woodlands

The nectar and pollen of eucalyptus trees provides food for birds such as this rainbow lorikeet and many species of honeyeater, while parrots eat the seeds.

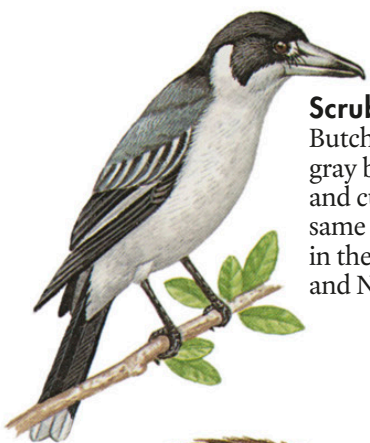


Rainforests

There are 41 species of birds-of-paradise, such as this Raggiana. Most live in the rainforests of New Guinea and surrounding islands. Four species live in Australia.

Typical birds

Here are just a few examples of typical birds from the most important habitats of Australasia. These range from rainforests, drier eucalyptus woodlands and grasslands, to deserts, scrubland, lakes, rivers, and swamps.



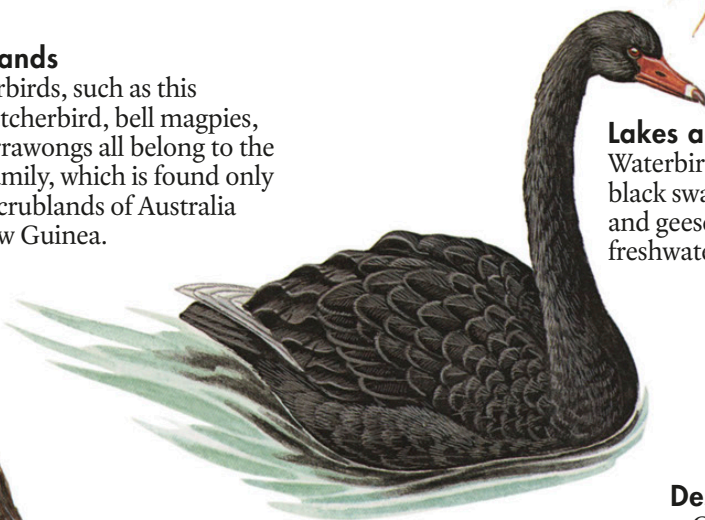
Scrublands

Butcherbirds, such as this gray butcherbird, bell magpies, and currawongs all belong to the same family, which is found only in the scrublands of Australia and New Guinea.



Islands

The brown kiwi is just one of many unique flightless birds that live only on the islands of New Zealand. They evolved at a time when there were few enemies to fly away from.



Lakes and rivers

Waterbirds, such as this black swan, as well as ducks and geese, feed and nest in freshwater habitats.



Deserts

Chats, such as this orange chat, and some parrots and pigeons manage to survive in deserts. They wander over large areas to find water and nest after rainfall, when insects start to hatch and plants grow.



Swamps

Birds such as the brolga nest in swamps, which provide shelter from predators and are a source of food such as fish. Other swamp birds include bitterns, egrets, herons, and ibises.